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ACCOUNTS PAYABLE

Version 3.5.2

Product Guide



FRONTISPIECE

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This product guide relates to: Accounts Payable Version 3.5.2

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Glossary



Glossary

1099

See Payment analysis.

Ad hoc Payment

A quick way of paying an item by creating a **payment cycle** for a single supplier. The payment request and the payment confirmation are made simultaneously, and the payment will be made through the normal payment procedure. See also **Manual payment**.

Application Interface

A System 21 application which extracts documents to be sent to a Trading Partner via EDI and adds them into EDI/400 for translation and transmission.

Conversely, it updates System 21 with information from documents received via EDI/400.

ANSI X.12

A message standard developed by the American National Standards Institute. Widely used in the United States.

Application Menus

A menu is a panel listing the functions available, and enabling the user to select a function. Menus may be tailored to a user's specific requirements.

Application Reference Data

This is the basic data set up by the user without which the application cannot function - for example, supplier details, or reason codes.

Archive

Facilities are provided whereby redundant or old data can be removed from the system. Archived data will normally be held on either magnetic tape or cartridge, and can be restored for enquiry and report purposes.

Audit Trail

It is vital that a complete record of all data entries and amendments be kept in order to comply with accounting regulations and to provide a means of tracking the provenance of any errors. The Accounts Payable application provides a full range of such auditing facilities.

BACS

Banks Automatic Clearing System; a procedure whereby payments may be made to suppliers electronically through the banks' computer systems.

Base Currency

When setting up a new company a base currency must be specified. This is the currency into which any non-base currency will be converted for the purposes of enquiry, reporting and accounting. Once postings have been made to the company the base currency cannot be changed, so it must be decided with care. If the Accounts Payable application is linked to a General Ledger, its base currency must be the same as that of the General Ledger.

Batch Control

The Company Profile can be set up to allow transactions to be posted in batches for control purposes. Accumulated batch values are then validated against a given batch total. Unlike **Session control**, this function is optional.

Bill of Exchange

See Collection document.

Collection Document

A collection document or bill of exchange is a guaranteed negotiable payment which may be issued *to* the company by its customers, or *by* the company to its suppliers as a promissory payment of an outstanding debt. When a collection document is accepted or issued, it is posted to the company's account to reduce the outstanding debt. On maturing, the document is exchanged for cash - as a payment or a receipt.

Company Profile

Accounts Payable is a multi-company application, and a number of parameters for each of its companies must be set up before the application can be run. The Company Profile contains all the basic rules within which a particular company is to operate.

Contra Accounting

A trading partner may often be both a supplier and a customer. Where this is the case, the contra accounts facility establishes a link between the supplier and customer accounts. This link causes an Accounts Payable payment to be reduced by the amount in the contra account in Accounts Receivable.

Control Account

The control account holds values posted from all the accounts of a sub-ledger beneath it. It cannot be posted to directly.

Country Code

Depending on where it is used, the country code may either control which *international* options are available to users, or it may simply control the format of the bank account window to appear when entering bank details.

Credit Note

Also called a *credit memo*. It is raised in Distribution or in Accounts Receivable, sometimes as a miscellaneous credit, but usually to cancel an invoice.

Cross Period Posting

If cross period postings are allowed for a supplier, a value posted to a General Ledger account in one dissection can be split over a number of G/L periods using a predefined spread profile.

It is not possible to post VAT using a cross period dissection.

Currency Code

In Accounts Payable, a default trading currency may be defined to a supplier, and a transaction may be entered in any currency defined to the system, provided that the company being used is defined as a multi-currency company. The three-character currency code refers to the currency to be used, and provides default exchange rates, etc.

Customs Invoice

Goods values and their associated VAT values are usually posted together. When goods are imported, however, the payments are sometimes made separately, with the VAT invoice arriving from Customs *after* the goods payment has been made. This means that the General Ledger is already updated, and the VAT must be posted to the VAT files without touching the General Ledger. The *Post Customs Invoice* option on the Accounts Payable Payments menu allows this to be done.

Default

A default value is a value stored by the system for use when no other value can be found. For example, when setting up supplier details, default payment terms can be entered. These payment terms will be used for any item which does not have its own payment terms defined.

Discount

Refers to settlement discount only. Trade or other discounts do not appear in Accounts Payable. A value or percentage to be deducted from the payment value if payment is made by the due date.

Dissection

The breakdown of a single transaction value across a number of General Ledger accounts, or to VAT codes.

Distribution Reference

The *Standard Distributions* option on the Accounts Payable Maintenance menu enables you to define to a distribution reference code how a posting is to be distributed among General Ledger codes. This can then be used as a default for supplier postings.

Due Date

The date on which payment of a transaction is due to your supplier.

EDI

Electronic Data Interchange. A method of transmitting business information over a Network, between Trading Partners who agree to follow approved national or industry standards in translating and exchanging information.

EDI/400

A PREMENOS module which receives standard Documents from a Network, translates them and adds them into the System 21 Application Interface database.

Conversely, it translates Documents output from the Application Interface into standard Documents. It then sends the Documents to a private or third party network.

Effectivity

It is often useful to be able to define the validity dates of an entity, so that the system can prevent its use outside of these dates. This period of validity is called an entity's *effectivity*.

Extended Terms

If payment of an item is to be spread over a period of time - paying different amounts each month, for example - then the best way to achieve this is to set up an extended terms code within the Cash Management application, and to define the payment terms to the code.

Flag

A trigger to activate or deactivate certain facilities and parameters within the application.

Historical Data

Application data which has been archived (i.e. is no longer considered current data), but which is retained (usually on tape), and may be restored for enquiries and reports.

Inter-company Accounting

You can flag any company as having inter-company status within the General Ledger. Having done so, you can link your company with other such companies within the same application. When posting transactions to another company, you merely have to specify that company's code and process the transaction in the normal way.

Item

In the Accounts Payable application, an item is a transaction document which has been entered onto the system.

Location

The location or department to which a log item is to be sent for authorisation.

Lockbox

Receive notification from your bank that cash has been paid into your account. Payment advice and remittance information (Tradacoms document type ANSI 823) is processed, validated and received from your bank via EDI.

Lockbox (non EDI) operates in the Cash Management module as the AR Interface Posting option to process valid receipts from your bank on magnetic tape.

Log

A means of registering the receipt of documents awaiting authorisation before they are posted to the company's accounts.

Manual Payment

Confirmation of payment already made to a supplier. This differs from an ad hoc payment in that a manual payment does not go through the payment cycle, and no documentation is produced, although a report can be run.

Mapping

Shows the relationship between Segments and Elements in a standard document and fields in the System 21 Application Interface database.

Menu

See Application Menu.

Multi-company

The software is designed to control more than one independent company, or several companies reporting to a controlling or reporting company.

Multi-currency

Trading in several currencies, linked to a single currency or multi-currency General Ledger.

Negative Balances

Supplier balances where the supplier owes money, e.g. an account showing a cash or credit note entry but no invoices.

Open Item

An open or outstanding item is an item which has been authorised but not yet fully paid.

Our Reference

This item reference number may, depending on the setting of the Company Profile, be allocated automatically by the system, or entered by the user.

Outstanding Item

See Open item

Parameter

A characteristic or constant factor defined by you or already in the system, which determines the specific form or specific limitations of a function.

Payment Analysis

This function enables you to keep track of payments made to contractors, and to report on such payments. The facility has a particular use in the USA, where notifying the government of payments to contractors is a legal requirement and is referred to as *1099*. The use of the function is decided by a flag when setting up the environment of a company - it is not a flag on the Company Profile.

Payment Cycle

The set of procedures by which suppliers are paid, from an analysis of payment due to actual payment.

Payment Method

The way in which a supplier is paid - for example, by cheque, collection documents or BACS

Payment Run

When items are selected for payment they are processed together in a batch job which produces the payment (e.g.: prints the cheques). This job is called a payment run.

Payment Terms

Defines the way in which the payment due date is calculated for each transaction. See also **Extended terms**.

Period

The units into which a financial year is divided for accounting purposes (usually 12 or 13). These are the same for each financial application.

Period Close/Open

The procedure which completes the processing for the current period. The next period may then be opened.

Prime Currency

The prime or *transaction* currency is the currency in which a transaction is made, as opposed to the **Base currency**, into which transaction values will be converted.

Prompt

A facility which brings up a list of records relating to a data entry field. To activate, enter a '?' and then press **F4**.

Protocol Number

The sequential number allocated to a VAT transaction in a *VAT register*. See **VAT registers**.

Reason Code

A code which may be used to define the reason for a credit note or journal.

Recurring Payments

This facility enables you to pay a supplier's recurring payments automatically. Three options on the Accounts Payable Maintenance menu enable you to set up recurring payments profiles which store the payment details, and three options on the Accounts Payable Payments menu enable these payments to be made.

Roll Keys

Keys used for the purpose of viewing the next 'page' of details. Also *roll up* and *roll down*.

Session Control

When starting to enter transactions, the system automatically sets up a session number. All transactions entered at once will then be part of that session. The

session is the principal method of control in transaction processing, and provides the information required to satisfy audit requirements.

Spread Elements

These are the elements which make up a complete **Extended terms** definition.

Status

Every **Open item** has a status assigned to it. The status, a numeric code, defines the payment rule for the item - it may be a 'prompt pay' item, to be paid immediately, or a status '1' item, which is to be included in the next payment run if its due date is reached, etc. The status can be maintained by the user.

Supplier Code

The unique identifier assigned to each of the company's suppliers. Each supplier may have multiple "delivery addresses". Payment may be made to a different "payee" code.

Supplier Reference

This is the reference on the document sent by the supplier.

Tradacoms

A message standard developed and supported in the UK by the ANA.

Trading Partner

A Customer or Supplier with whom there is an agreement to exchange documents electronically.

Transaction

A general term used to describe a unit of financial data submitted to the application - such as an invoice.

Transaction Currency

Same as Prime currency

Transfer

The journal used to correct a mis-posting from one account to another.

Utilities

A set of procedures for verification, utilisation and management of the application database. They are not required during normal operation, and when used may require technical support.

VAT Accounting

The way in which Value Added Tax is posted, recorded and accounted for. See "VAT Sub-system" in General Ledger for more details.

VAT Registers

This is a facility to enable the producing of VAT reports based on tax area. The codes are set up in General Ledger by the user, and relate to a particular tax office. This facility will be used mainly in Italy.

Withholding Tax

This function is essentially a form of advance income tax. When a sub-contractor submits an invoice, part of the invoice payment is retained by the paying company and paid directly to the government. This payment is known as *withholding tax*.

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